

SOUTH AMERICA

Although South America is much poorer than its northern neighbor, it is rich in natural resources. Its mineral wealth led to its invasion by the Portuguese and Spanish in the 1500s, and their languages and culture still shape the lives of the people here. The nations below are listed in order of area, headed by Brazil—the world's fifth largest country.

Brazil   3,287,957 sq miles 8,515,770 sq km  205,824,000  Brasília  Portuguese, German, Italian, Spanish, Polish, Japanese, Amerindian languages		Venezuela   352,144 sq miles 912,050 sq km  30,912,000  Caracas  Spanish, Amerindian languages		Latin American culture is world famous, thanks to its infectious music and dance. Here a couple in Buenos Aires, Argentina, demonstrate the art of the tango.
	Bolivia   424,164 sq miles 1,098,581 sq km  10,970,000  La Paz  Aymara, Quechua, Spanish	Chile   291,933 sq miles 756,102 sq km  17,650,000  Santiago  Spanish, Amerindian languages		
Argentina   1,073,518 sq miles 2,780,400 sq km  43,887,000  Buenos Aires  Spanish, Italian, Amerindian languages		Paraguay   157,048 sq miles 406,752 sq km  6,863,000  Asunción  Guaraní, Spanish, German		Ecuador   109,484 sq miles 283,561 sq km  16,081,000  Quito  Spanish, Quechua, other Amerindian languages
Peru   496,225 sq miles 1,285,216 sq km  30,741,000  Lima  Spanish, Quechua, Aymara				Guyana   83,000 sq miles 214,969 sq km  736,000  Georgetown  English Creole, Hindi, Tamil, Amerindian languages, English
				Uruguay   68,037 sq miles 176,215 sq km  3,351,000  Montevideo  Spanish
Colombia   439,736 sq miles 1,138,910 sq km  47,221,000  Bogotá  Spanish, Wayuu, Páez, and other Amerindian languages				Suriname   63,251 sq miles 163,820 sq km  585,800  Paramaribo  Sranan (creole), Dutch, Javanese, Sarnami Hindi, Saramaccan (creole), Chinese, Carib
	Soccer is a national passion in Brazil. Most of these barefoot boys on Ipanema beach, Rio de Janeiro, will be dreaming of playing for Brazil in the World Cup.			